Carl Drechsel

Cloud & AI Transformation Leader | Enterprise Digital Workplace Strategy | Microsoft Ecosystem Architect

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Enterprise AI Transformation and Digital Workplace leader with 20+ years leading large-scale cloud, collaboration, and identity transformation initiatives, including cross-functional team leadership and enterprise delivery. Combines deep Microsoft ecosystem expertise (Microsoft 365, Azure, identity, and security) with executive advisory experience to help organizations integrate AI capabilities into real enterprise workflows and decision-making environments.

- **AI Enablement:** Enterprise readiness, governance, and productivity transformation aligned with Microsoft Copilot and generative AI capabilities
- **Business Value:** Aligns technology investments to measurable outcomes, including a **$5M enterprise licensing optimization**.
- **Strategic Focus:** Redesigning knowledge work through AI-enabled workflow transformation, decision intelligence, and productivity acceleration

STRATEGY & ARCHITECTURE EXPERTISE

Digital workplace transformation • AI adoption & governance (Copilot) • Technology strategy, operating model design, and delivery alignment • Executive advisory & stakeholder engagement • Change management & adoption strategy • Business case & ROI development • Team leadership, mentoring, and cross-functional delivery alignment

Microsoft 365 & Azure platforms • Identity architecture & Zero Trust • Enterprise collaboration platforms • Cloud architecture (SaaS / IaaS / PaaS) • Compliance & data protection • Infrastructure modernization

ENTERPRISE AI ENABLEMENT

Lead enterprise AI enablement initiatives across Azure and Microsoft 365 environments, translating emerging AI capabilities into scalable solutions that improve productivity, decision-making, and collaboration.

- Designed AI readiness strategies aligned to enterprise architecture, identity, governance, and Microsoft 365 platforms including Copilot
- Identified workflow inefficiencies and implemented AI-enabled solutions to improve productivity and operational outcomes
- Developed frameworks for embedding AI into collaboration ecosystems (Teams, SharePoint, Microsoft 365) within existing enterprise workflows
- Advise enterprise leaders and lead cross-functional teams on AI governance, adoption, and measurable value realization

AI PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT | SalesInsight — AI Sales Intelligence Platform (Founder / Architect)

Led the design and development of an applied AI platform that transforms unstructured sales conversations into structured intelligence used for deal strategy, opportunity analysis, and proposal development.

- Designed structured Sales Intelligence Briefs that convert conversation data into strategic deal and execution insights
- Built a workflow architecture combining LLM-based analysis, structured output models, and automation to accelerate proposal generation and opportunity alignment
- Demonstrates applied use of AI to enhance enterprise knowledge workflows, decision clarity, and execution outcomes

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Global Technology Consulting Firm | **Senior Solutions Architect - Enterprise AI Enablement & Digital Workplace** | *July 2022 – Present*

Lead enterprise cloud and AI transformation engagements across Azure and Microsoft 365 environments, driving delivery across complex, multi-stakeholder initiatives.

- Drive execution across multiple engagements by aligning stakeholders, removing delivery blockers, and ensuring successful outcomes
- Lead Azure-based solution design and implementation approaches, ensuring alignment to enterprise architecture, identity, and governance models
- Mentor and support technical professionals through coaching, interview participation, and strategic resource evaluation
- Navigate complex enterprise environments and stakeholder dynamics to resolve delivery challenges and maintain engagement momentum
- Collaborate with sales, delivery, and partner teams to align solution strategy and execution across customer engagements

Key Strategic Engagements:

Global Investment Firm – Enterprise EUX Transformation Strategy

- Led enterprise EUX transformation strategy spanning device lifecycle modernization, identity alignment, and collaboration governance
- Identified workflow friction impacting workforce productivity and guided discussions on future productivity enablement including emerging AI capabilities

Regional Healthcare System – Microsoft 365 Tenant Consolidation

- Consolidated multiple Microsoft 365 tenants into a unified collaboration platform reducing operational complexity
- Improved cross-organization collaboration through unified identity services

Global Insurance Provider – Security & Risk Governance

- Architected Insider Risk Management and Communications Compliance capabilities supporting regulatory obligations
- Strengthened governance visibility through Microsoft 365 E5 security controls

Large U.S. Financial Institution – Teams Compliance Architecture

- Designed and piloted Teams compliance architecture supporting retention, supervision, and policy enforcement
- Enabled regulatory recordkeeping and supervisory control workflows

National Healthcare Organization – Security & Compliance Assessment

- Assessed identity and data protection risks within Microsoft 365 environment
- Delivered prioritized remediation roadmap strengthening security controls

Global Technology Consulting Firm | **Senior Solutions Architect - Microsoft Security & Modern Workplace |** *August 2021 – July 2022*

Recruited to lead the development of Microsoft security consulting capabilities within the consulting services organization, establishing service offerings, shaping go-to-market strategy, and supporting early-stage customer engagements.

- Led the build-out of Microsoft security consulting services, defining offerings aligned to Microsoft 365 security, compliance, and identity solutions
- Partnered with sales and leadership to shape engagements and drive early adoption, translating customer requirements into scoped solutions and delivery approaches
- Contributed to go-to-market strategy and positioned Microsoft security capabilities within enterprise accounts to drive consulting opportunities
- Transitioned into modern work and AI-focused engagements following organizational realignment, applying prior experience to broader digital workplace and transformation initiatives

Regional Financial Institution | **Enterprise Architect III, AVP — Enterprise Infrastructure (End User Services)** | *September 2019 – August 2021*

Domain architect responsible for modern workplace strategy across collaboration platforms, identity architecture, and workforce productivity services.

Defined enterprise technology direction supporting secure, scalable digital workplace services for a large financial services environment.

- Led early Azure adoption strategy, establishing foundational cloud direction aligned to identity, security, and enterprise workloads
- **Cost Optimization:** Directed Microsoft licensing strategy generating **$5M in savings** through persona-based optimization.
- **Modernization:** Developed Zero Trust identity blueprint and virtual desktop strategy for cloud-delivered workspaces.
- **Governance:** Led architecture governance for enterprise migration to Microsoft 365.

Regional Financial Institution | **Technical Engineer IV, Bank Officer |***December 2015 – September 2019*

Led technical architecture and delivery for enterprise collaboration modernization initiatives.

- Led enterprise Office 365 deployment enabling secure modern collaboration.
- Designed Azure AD Connect & Conditional Access supporting identity-as-a-service.
- Implemented MFA and governance controls supporting 20,000+ users.

Global Managed Services Provider (Industrial Sector Client) | **Senior Messaging Engineer** | *October 2012 – December 2015*

- Migrated 120,000 mailboxes across global environment.
- Developed automated monitoring improving uptime and reducing incidents.

Enterprise Software Company | **Senior Technical Product Manager |** *January 2011 – October 2012*

Defined product strategy and architecture for Microsoft Exchange and SharePoint monitoring solutions - Speaker at Microsoft Tech-Ed North America 2012

Global Enterprise Services Organization | **Senior Global Messaging & Collaboration Engineer** | *September 2006 – December 2010*

- Consolidated 82 global email systems into a unified architecture for 100,000 users.
- Designed disaster recovery and business continuity strategy.

CERTIFICATIONS - Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) • Microsoft 365 Certified: Security Administrator Associate *(expired)*

EDUCATION - MBA, SUNY Buffalo • BS, Management & Marketing, Canisius College • AAS, Business Administration, Erie Community College